

Napzilla Games Landor's Cottage Website Identity V2

“How do we make someone feel like they've already begun the journey before they've even played the game?”

The website should be created to answer such a question. While the website still has practical responsibilities, introducing Napzilla Games, showcasing Landor's Cottage, and giving players somewhere to follow development, those should be delivered through the experience rather than separate from it. Establishing a main objective helps us decide the identity. The website should first feel like an extension of the game's world. It should invite visitors into the same atmosphere, emotions, and curiosity that the game itself is built around.

This isn't intended to be a complete blueprint or final website design document. Think of it as Version 1 of the website's identity, a shared direction that future design decisions can build upon and refine.

Note: Poe's identity and perspective are intentionally left ambiguous. The website should not confirm that the visitor is Poe. Instead, the visitor occupies the position of the traveller and is free to interpret who they are. Hence the term, “the visitor” is used, referring directly to not only the person who is browsing the website or the player playing the game rather the person who is experiencing the journey as a whole.

The Anchor

Observation Through Environment

In Landor's Cottage, the environment isn't simply the backdrop. It is one of the story's main characters. The landscape ties well with what happens throughout most of the story: observation. Every major emotion in the game is communicated through what the *visitor* sees, hears, feels before it is communicated through dialogue. The perfect trails, the quiet river, the open valley, the warmth of the cottage, even the fog all tell the visitor something long before a character speaks. Beauty happens naturally; perfection does not. The website should follow the same philosophy. It is imperative that we strike a balance between invoking the senses and telling the story.

Some key concepts we could include:

1. Light

Light represents guidance, direction, and the idea that something peaceful waits ahead.

It constantly draws both the visitor and Ponto forward. Rather than treating light as decoration, it should become a storytelling tool throughout the site interface.

2. Fog/Darkness

Fog isn't simply darkness. It represents uncertainty. Throughout the journey, the visitor is constantly uncovering more of the world around them. Bad decisions based on uncertainty lead to an unfortunate end. The website can use fog in much the same way, gradually revealing content rather than presenting everything immediately. Imagine a layer of fog sitting at the bottom of the viewport, slowly revealing new parts of the journey as the visitor scrolls. This is something we can do.

3. The Journal

Rather than using journal pages purely as decoration, they can become one of the website's primary storytelling devices. In fact, since the main theme is observation, the journal pages are our instrument of delivery. As the visitor progresses through the site, scattered pages can appear naturally between sections. Internal monologues that convey thoughts, emotions and questions. For example, a simple observation such as *"The road was strangely well kept."* delivers information while still leaving the identity of the writer open. Besides reinforcing the atmosphere, the journal also gives us a natural way to communicate information without relying on large blocks of traditional UI.

4. Ponto

Ponto isn't just the visitor's companion; he's also the visitor's guide. That makes him an interesting but important metaphor for website navigation. Rather than becoming a mascot, Ponto could subtly guide the reader through the experience, appearing occasionally as sketches, footprints, or small environmental cues that naturally encourage scrolling.

Visual Core

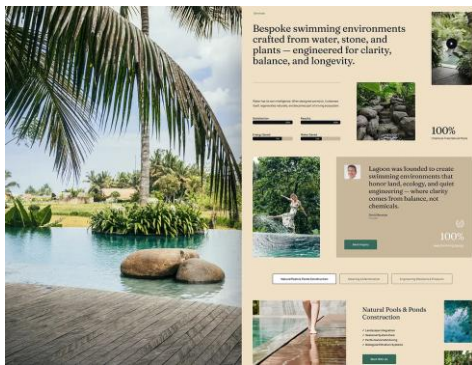


The Beeches

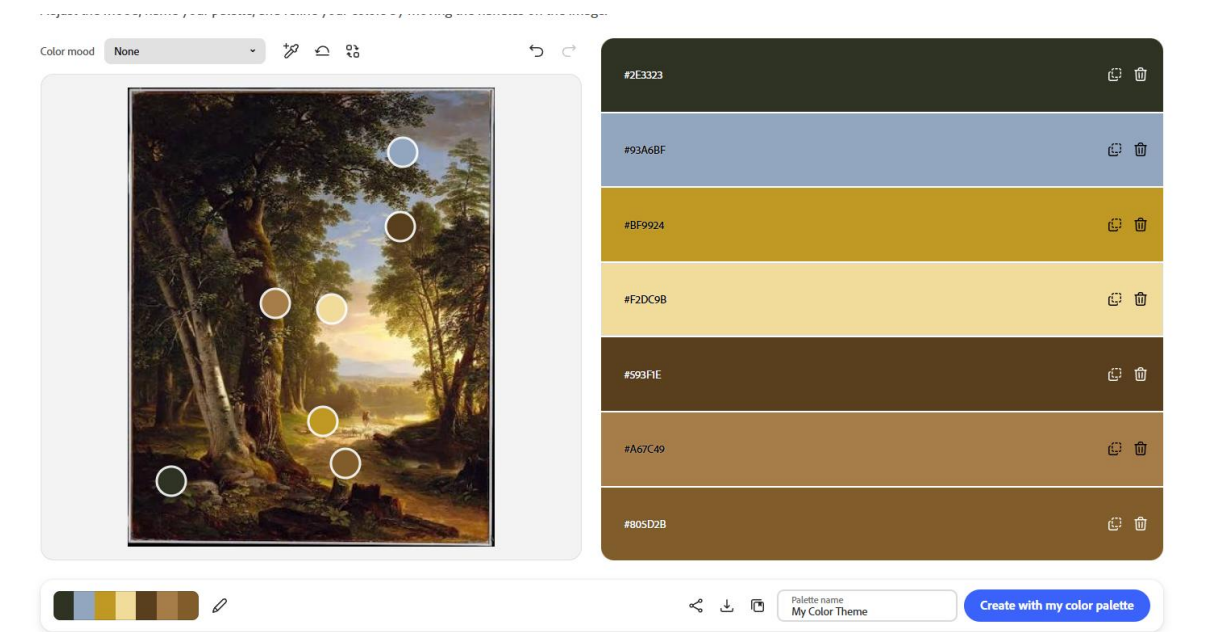
Asher Brown Durand

1845

The art bible states that the game looks like a Hudson School painting. Therefore, the visual direction should feel painted before it feels digital. Colours including forest green (vegetation), deep browns (land and path) and golden-hour ochre (yellow-orange? Light). The image above displays what visual style the site aims to achieve. It's important to tie this back to the anchor, the environment. The website can look something akin to the following colour reference:



It's important to note that this is a swimming pool website example so no functional nor structural correlation. The image is only used with references to the colours, how green and beige complement each other. The beige will be replaced with a darker brown. From these two reference images this colour code is constructed:



From left to right / Top to bottom:

#2E3323 – Primary for buttons/ interactive content
#93A6BF – Used scarcely (Possibly Fog?)
#BF9924 – Primary for buttons/ interactive content/ Light spots
#F2DC9B – Background Main
#593F1E – Background Secondary
#A67C49 – Alternative background colour
#805D2B – journal pages

Black and white will also be included as text colours in the corresponding spaces. For example, journal pages will have black text as this is the standard while white may be incorporated on darker spaces.

Important Note:

The established colours are for the main site identity. We still need to factor the maze section part of the story and their correlation to the Red Death. Colours including:

Order	Colour	Meaning on the website
1	Blue	Dream, water, uncertainty, beginning
2	Green	Life, nature, harmony
3	Orange	Growth, warmth, cultivated beauty
4	White	Purity, stillness
5	Violet	Romance, memory, mystery
6	Red	Mortality, danger, warning
7	Black (with grey)	Death, endings, revelation

Exact colour codes haven't been decided yet other than the primary colour palette.

Imagery

Imagery will likely become the website's strongest storytelling tool. Every image should reinforce the journey rather than simply showcase the game. Remember the anchor? We need the visitor to observe and experience rather than simply read. Trails, rivers,

forests, sunlight breaking through trees, distant views of the cottage, and environmental details all contribute to the feeling that the visitor is experiencing this world.

Typography

A couple of options come to mind with regards to fonts. We could pair them such:

Main (Headings and Key content): [Lora](#)

Main (Headings and Key content): [EB Garamond](#)

Main/Sub (Headings, Journal Entries, sub content): [IM Fell Great Primer](#)

Minimal Content: [Reenie Beanie](#)

Lora – A contemporary serif with brushed curves, giving it a subtle artistic, painted feel
EB Garamond – A classic, timeless book typeface that feels inherently literary and historic.

IM Fell DW Pica Prose - Italicised digital versions of real historic typefaces.

Reenie Beanie – Raw, sketch like font that works well for the authentic journal aesthetic.

Spacing

The website shouldn't feel dense or rushed. The story takes its time revealing the small details, so the interface should feel the same, allowing each section room to breathe. Generous spacing between sections creates moments of silence, encouraging the visitor to slow down instead of rushing through content. This quiet pacing mirrors the rhythm of the game itself. References that capture this feeling particularly well include the editorial layouts used by Apple, Aesop, and the environmental storytelling found on the Firewatch website. Their use of whitespace allows each visual element to become part of the narrative rather than competing for attention.

Tone

Even though no copy has been established yet we can already construct a desired tone. Words on website are just as important. Using words such as warm compared to hot conveys a different atmosphere. Certain sections of the website will illustrate the uncertainty that the visitor should feel, while others will highlight assurance in their guide Ponto. The website should speak with quiet confidence, inviting curiosity rather than demanding attention.

Audio?

If the decision is taken to introduce audio to the website, it should be more than simply adding background music. Just like the game, ambience should take priority. The sound

of running water suggests clarity, the wind subtly draws the visitor forward, and distant birds reinforce the feeling of a living landscape. Even silence has a role to play. It shouldn't be treated simply as the absence of sound, but as another storytelling device, creating moments of uncertainty, reflection, and anticipation.

Structure

1. Opening (The landing section)

The visitor's first impression should be the beauty of the valley. A winding trail, the river, and Landor's Cottage resting quietly in the distance establish both the destination and the emotional tone of the experience. This creates a sense of anticipation.

2. The Traveller

The visitor is not introduced as Poe, nor are they given a defined identity. Instead, they occupy the position of **the visitor** moving through this world. The website should allow them to observe, discover, and interpret what they encounter without confirming who they are. Whether they see themselves as Poe, another traveller, or simply themselves is intentionally left open.

3. The Journey

We talk more about the road to Landor's cottage. Not exact spoilers, just pieces to create a desire to explore.

4. The destination?

More insight on Landor's Cottage? Why should the visitor embark on this journey? Is it the end or rather a beginning to something else.

5. So where does Napzilla Games come into all of this?

Since Landor's Cottage is currently the studio's flagship project, it naturally becomes the visitor's introduction to Napzilla Games. Rather than presenting ourselves immediately, we first establish curiosity and emotional investment through the game itself. Once visitors understand the world they're stepping into, we introduce the people creating it. From there, dedicated sections can focus on the studio, the team, community links, development updates, and future projects.

End of v1, please note this document is subject to change, just my current direction -
Tino